Evan Hicks

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Education

University of Victoria - 2nd year Sep 2025 - Expected May 2029

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Language and Technologies

- **Languages:** Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript
- **Technologies:** Expo, React, React Native, Node.js, Flask, PostgreSQL, Git, Computer Vision, Twilio

Projects

HoldVision - Computer Vision Climbing Route Grader [demo↗] Jan 2026 - Present

- Built a cross-platform mobile app in React Native and Expo where climbers photograph or upload a wall, select their route's holds, and receive an estimated V-grade.
- Integrated a YOLOv8 hold-detection model behind a Python Flask API, added rule-based post-processing that corrects likely misclassifications using hold size, and built an editing flow so users can fix hold types before grading. Fixing holds feeds back into training the model.
- Built an editing flow where users fix misclassified holds before grading, and saved those corrections as labeled data to automatically retrain the model.
- Designed a heuristic V-grade scoring algorithm that weights each move by hold type and the distance between hand positions, and reduces difficulty when a volume sits below the move.

Bouncer - SMS Accountability Bot [demo↗] Sep 2026 - Present

- Built a two-way SMS accountability bot with Node.js, Express, and Twilio, using the Gemini API to generate replies in a consistent persona and storing recent chat history in Supabase for context.
- Parsed structured JSON tags from LLM replies to turn free-text messages into scheduled reminders, reschedules, cancellations, and timezone updates, with a cron-triggered endpoint that sends escalating nudges before, at, and after the deadline.
- Added a three-day free trial and Stripe checkout, with a signature-verified webhook that upgrades users to paid status, and deployed the service on Render.

Volunteer

Instructor – Cyber Seniors, Victoria October 2024 - June 2025

- Taught seniors how to use computers and smartphones using a simple curriculum.
- Aided seniors with technology issues such as viruses and network issues.

Other Work Experience

Dishwasher and Prep – Shine Cafe, Victoria April 2025 - April 2026

- Balanced a consistent weekend work schedule with a full-time academic load at UVic.
- Collaborated with coworkers to serve customers in a timely manner.